Theodore Garcia

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EDUCATION

De La Salle University Manila, Philippines
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, major in Network and Information Security 2024 – 2028 (expected)

- Dean's Lister, Terms 1–6 (every term to date)
- DOST Merit Scholar, Department of Science and Technology undergraduate scholarship

Elizabeth Seton School Las Piñas City, Philippines
Senior High School, Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) strand

- Ranked in the top 20% of the STEM batch; Excellence Award (With Honors) and Annual Excellence Award (With Honors)

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified: ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC); AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner; AWS Certified AI Practitioner

Skill badges: IBM SkillsBuild: GRC and Data Privacy; Vulnerability Management; System and Network Security; Cloud Security

Working toward: CompTIA Security+; AWS Certified Security Specialty; ISO/IEC 27001 Lead Auditor or Lead Implementer (PECB); ISACA CISA or CRISC

PROJECTS

DarkHole V2 Penetration Test Team project
Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (Nmap, Nessus, Burp Suite, sqlmap) Jul – Aug 2026

- Performed a black-box internal test of a Linux host and its PHP web application under a defined scope and rules of engagement.
- Validated scanner output by hand and chained five weaknesses (exposed .git repository, hardcoded credentials, SQL injection, cron command injection, password reuse with sudo) into full root access.
- Co-authored a 39-page findings report: 13 findings (2 Critical, 5 High) with CVSS 3.1 vectors and prioritized remediation.

AuditBridge, Compliance Mapping and Risk Register Engine Personal project
Python In progress

- Collects findings from CIS configuration checks, Nmap service scans and read-only web checks in a lab, with severity and evidence.
- Maps each finding to ISO/IEC 27001, NIST SP 800-53, PCI DSS, SOC 2, OWASP and CIS controls, with the rationale documented.
- Scores risk on an explainable 5×5 likelihood and impact scale; exports risk registers (CSV/XLSX), compliance report cards and an HTML heat map.

Project Sinag, Filipino Sunshine Powerhouse Realty Client project
TypeScript, Node.js, Express, MySQL, React, Tailwind CSS Oct 2026 – present

- Building, with a seven-person Scrum team, a web app replacing a brokerage's Excel files: listings, inquiries, viewings, referrals, commissions.
- Set up the architecture, MySQL migrations, CI (111 API tests per pull request) and the Scrum process; wrote the log-in, role checks, audit log, event bus and consent modules.
- Security: bcrypt; HttpOnly, SameSite, HTTPS-only session cookies with a 30-minute idle timeout and a new ID at log-in; a lockout after 5 failures that treats unknown e-mails the same, so no response reveals which accounts exist.
- Data Privacy Act (RA 10173): versioned privacy notices, consent saved in the same transaction as each form, anonymizing withdrawal, and e-mails kept only as SHA-256 fingerprints in events and audit logs.

Galicious Secret Scanner Team project
Python, Flask, SARIF 2.1.0

- Co-developed a scanner that finds leaked credentials in folders and GitHub repositories, including secrets deleted from the latest commit but still in Git history.
- Combines regex signatures with a Shannon-entropy check and an opt-in validity test against AWS STS, GitHub, Stripe and Slack; every output is redacted.
- Tested against VulnRepo, a purpose-built repository with history-only secrets and decoys that must not be flagged.

PinoyFlex Team project
React, Vite, Node.js, Express, MongoDB Atlas 2026

- Full-stack fitness community app built by a five-person team: posts, comments, follows, workout logs, badges, notifications and user reports with admin moderation; deployed on Render.
- Security: bcrypt password hashing; httpOnly, SameSite and production-only Secure session cookies; role-based access control with suspended accounts; rate limiting on login and the API; generic login errors that don't reveal which usernames exist.

Pablings Payroll Client project
Electron, SheetJS

- Built a local-first Windows payroll app for a working barbershop that turns the weekly Google Sheet export into commissions, allowances, late deductions and net pay, then exports payslips in the shop's layout.
- Kept employee pay data on the owner's machine, with no cloud service and no database.

Prompt-a-thon Practice App Personal project

Node.js, Express, Claude API

- Built a starter app for the LSCS Prompt-a-thon that streams Claude API replies to a chat UI with a live-editable system prompt.
- Added a mock mode that runs without an API key, and kept keys in an ignored .env file.

VoIP over SIP/RTP Course project

Java, UDP

- Built a Java voice-call client: SIP/SDP signaling over UDP, RTP audio and RTCP sender reports every 5 seconds.
- Supported file, one-way and two-way call modes with clean teardown between calls.

CatBot Course project

Python, reinforcement learning

- Built a tabular Q-learning agent that catches cats with different movement styles on an 8×8 grid, evaluated over 20 games against 5 graded cats plus unseen behaviors.

UiPath Automation Personal project

Robotic process automation, UiPath Studio

- Built an automation workflow in UiPath Studio, with a recorded demo of it running.

COMPETITIONS AND WRITEUPS

Packet Capture: Beyond the Network CTF, CyberPH and MQ CyberSec Club

14th of 164 teams (top 9%) 2026

- Solved OSINT, web exploitation, digital and network forensics and steganography challenges; published 16 step-by-step writeups (github.com/theoithinkk/CTFwriteups).

K17 CTF 2026, UNSW Security Society Online

Team SlayTheFlagII: 152nd of 682 teams (top 23%) Sep 2026

- Solved cryptography, digital forensics, reverse engineering, web exploitation, OSINT and miscellaneous challenges.

ISO 2026 CTF: Uncharted Knowledge, Information Security Organization, DLSU Manila, Philippines

2nd place 2026

- Solved cryptography, OS and Linux, digital forensics, web, metadata analysis, OSINT and steganography challenges.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

La Salle Computer Society Manila, Philippines

Associate Vice President for Academics Sep 2025 – Sep 2026

- Directed pre-event operations for 10+ academic events: technical talks, exam reviews, publications and coding competitions.
- Coordinated scheduling, documentation and stakeholder communication with faculty and partner departments.

Junior Officer, Research and Development Oct 2024 – Sep 2025

- Helped plan and run the Research and Development committee's events.

DLSU SPRINT Manila, Philippines

Associate Vice President for Human Resource Development Sep 2025 – Sep 2026

- Led member engagement for 30+ members of an invite-only leadership organization through 3+ team-building and development initiatives.

Computer Studies Government, De La Salle University Manila, Philippines

Executive for Internal Relations Sep 2024 – Oct 2025

- Point of contact between the student government, 10+ student organizations and the Dean's Office; ran internal communications.

DLSU ACM Student Chapter Manila, Philippines

Associate for Activities Oct 2024 – Oct 2025

- Ran the chapter's general assemblies and lab orientations for members.

RESEARCH

Senior high research: Outstanding Research Award, Elizabeth Seton School; oral presenter, PAREF Southridge Research Congress

SKILLS

GRC and privacy: ISO/IEC 27001, NIST SP 800-53, CIS Benchmarks, PCI DSS, SOC 2, RA 10173 (Data Privacy Act), 5×5 risk scoring, risk registers, control mapping, policy and SOP drafting

Cloud and AI: AWS core services, AWS IAM, shared responsibility model, GitHub Actions, Claude API

Offensive security: Burp Suite, Nmap (NSE), Nessus, sqlmap, Nikto, Kali Linux, OWASP Top 10, CVSS 3.1

Languages: Python, JavaScript, Java, C, SQL, PHP, Rust, Bash, HTML, CSS

Tools and frameworks: Linux, Git, GitHub, Flask, Node.js, Express, Electron, Google Apps Script, Microsoft 365, Excel